MICROBURBS HACKATHON

Which building a flat is in sets its rent.

Its floor barely does.

Two weekly rents, with and without a car space, for all 65,777 City of Sydney flats, and a rent check any tenant can use.

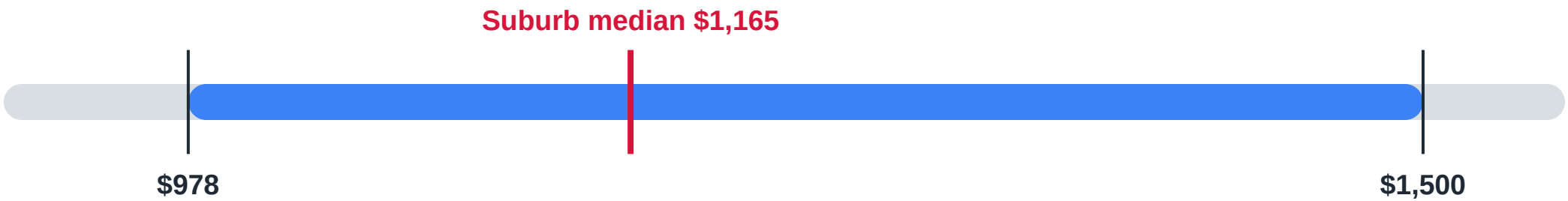
microburbsdataanalysis.vercel.app

Rents task, 7 November 2026

THE PROBLEM

A suburb median misses a flat's rent by $100 a week.

2-bedroom flats with parking in Zetland: one suburb, one flat type, 96 buildings with at least five adverts.



Typical weekly asking rent of each building, brought forward to April 2026

$522
a week between the cheapest and dearest building

$100
typical miss for suburb, bedrooms and parking

56.8%
of asks within $100 with the suburb method

WHAT WE FOUND

The building sets the rent. Height, once the building is known, adds almost nothing.

$522

Spread across Zetland buildings for one flat type. Waterloo: $905 to $1,376.

$1.46

a week per floor, across 18,153 adverts in 1,709 same-building groups.

$76

a week for a car space, about $3,971 a year. Studio $32, 3-bedroom $105.

- 11.9% of new asks were more than $100 above their building's going rate. In Surry Hills and Potts Point, about 17%.
- Flats in fast-growing blocks (homes up more than 30% since 2021) asked 2.5% above their suburb. Blocks with no new homes asked 2.6% below.
- Relisted flats asked 3.8% more than last time, but 0.6% less once the market move is taken out.

HOW WE ESTIMATE

Start with the narrowest evidence, widen only when it runs out.

This flat's own past asks

75% of the weight where it advertised before

→

Same building

bedrooms, bathrooms, parking; one advert is enough

→

10 nearest buildings

within 1 km, where the building never advertised

→

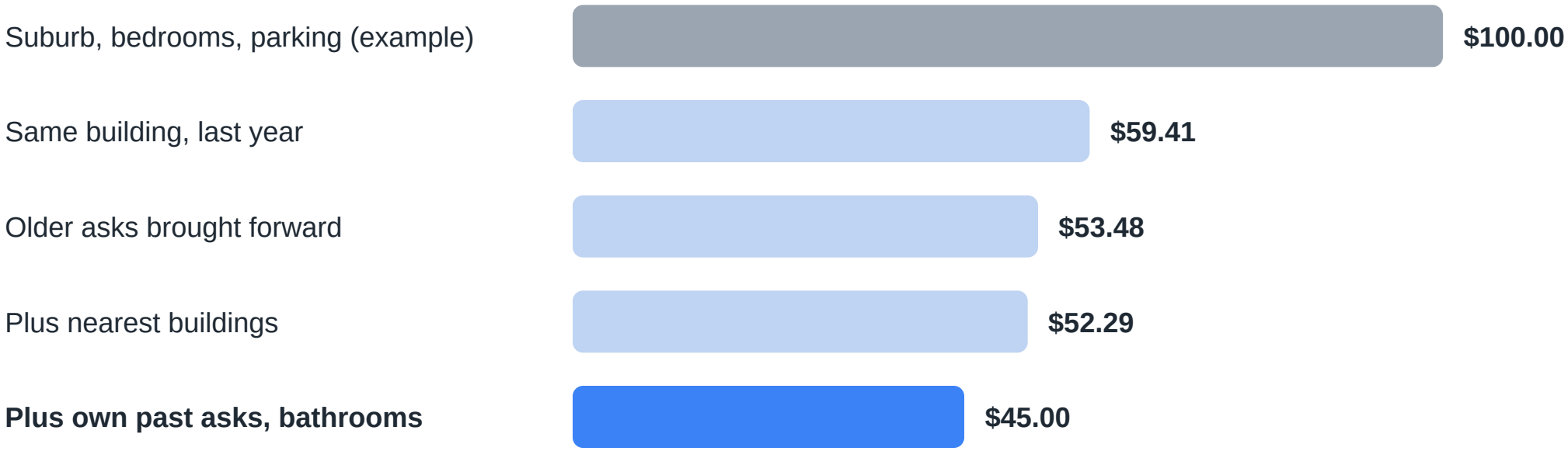
Suburb, then bedrooms

only when nothing is in reach

- Every older ask is brought forward with a city-wide quarterly index, then weighted down as it ages (three-year half-life).
- Where a building only advertised one parking answer, the other rent adds or removes the local car-space gap.
- Nothing dated after 31 July 2026 is read. No live listings.

SEPARATE CHECK: 3,954 ADVERTS, MAY TO JULY 2026

Typical miss: $100 down to $45 a week.



77.1%

of asks within $100 (was 56.8%)

0.872

R squared: share of rent variation explained (was 0.645)

$0.97

typical bias: half asked more, half asked less

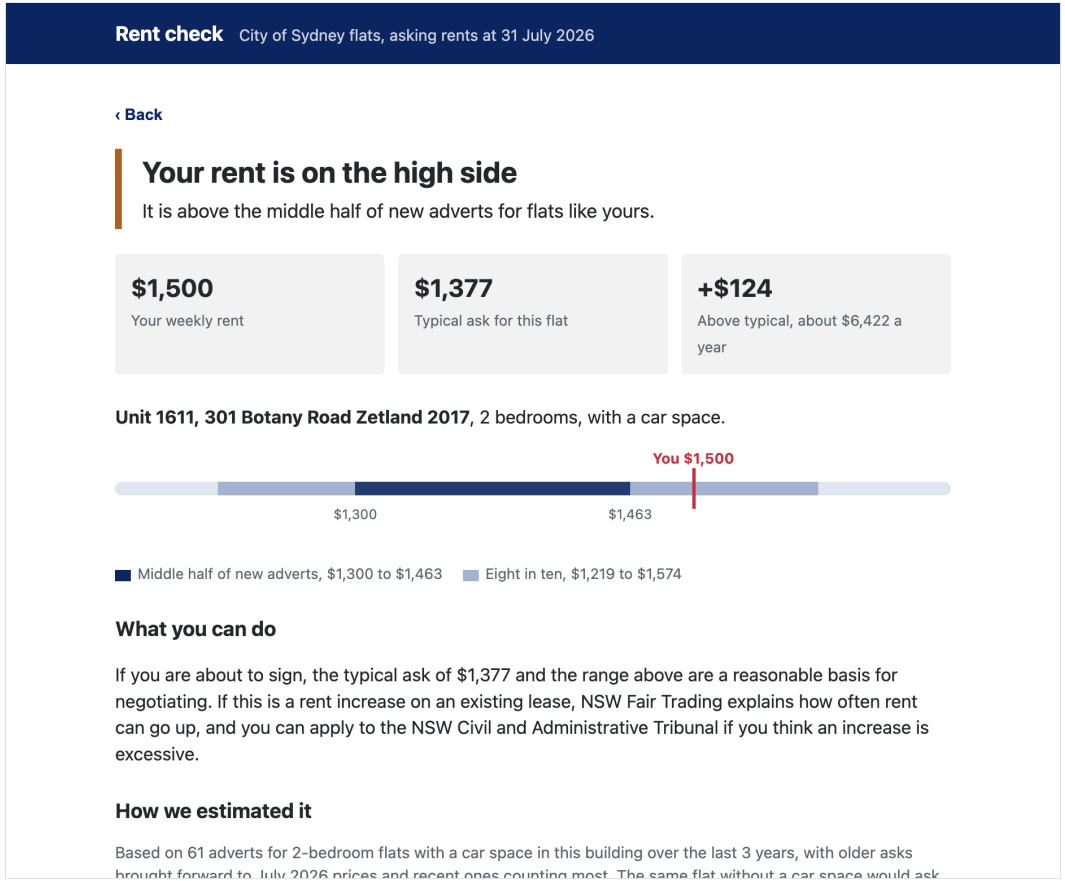
WHY YOU CAN TRUST IT

Tuned on the past, scored once on adverts it never saw.

- Every setting was chosen on three earlier folds: Aug-Oct 2025, Nov 2025-Jan 2026 and Feb-Apr 2026. The May-July 2026 adverts were scored once, after the rule was frozen.
- No drift across the test window: May $44.12, June $43.53, July $49.04. The hidden ads run two months past the as-at date.
- Rebuilt before each of seven earlier quarters, the typical miss stayed between $50 and $62.
- Drawing 1,699 adverts at random (the hidden set's size) 2,000 times: typical miss $42.38 to $47.30, nine times in ten.
- Floor level was tested the same way and dropped: it made two of the three folds worse.

THE PRODUCT

A rent check any City of Sydney tenant can use in 20 seconds.



- Find your flat from 65,777 addresses: '1406/157 Redfern St' or 'Unit 1611, 301 Botany Rd'.
- Bedrooms and parking come pre-filled from the flat's records.
- See your rent against the typical ask, the middle half of new adverts, and the dollars a year at stake.
- Ranges tighten with evidence: 7.4% wide where the flat advertised before, 13% from its building alone.

microburbsdataanalysis.vercel.app

WHO IT HELPS

One estimate, three decisions.

Tenants

Check an advert or a rent rise against the same building before signing. 11.9% of asks sat more than $100 above the building's rate.

Landlords and agents

Price against their own building and flat type, with and without a car space, instead of a suburb figure that can be $300 off.

Microburbs

Building-level rent for every flat in the city, ready for property profiles, rental yield and the Median Mirage story.

WHAT REMAINS UNCERTAIN

Honest limits, and what we would add next.

Limits

- Buildings that never advertised a flat type still miss by about $98 a week, against $43 with building evidence.
- Flats that never advertised themselves can expect nearer $59 than $45.
- Condition, view and orientation are not in the data.

Next

- Microburbs API features (stations, schools, development) for the never-advertised buildings.
- Refresh monthly so every tenant check uses the latest asks.
- Rent-rise alerts: flag increases far above the building's own movement.

45-SECOND PITCH (PITCH.MP4)

Script

0-8 s	Two buildings in Zetland. Same suburb, same flat: two bedrooms with parking. One asks $978 a week, the other $1,500. The suburb median says $1,165 for both.
8-18 s	We found that the building a flat is in sets its rent. Its floor barely matters: about $1.46 a week per floor.
18-32 s	So we price every one of the 65,777 City of Sydney flats from its own past adverts and its own building, with and without a car space. On adverts we held back, the typical miss is $45 a week, against $100 for the suburb method. More than three in four land within $100.
32-45 s	And any tenant can use it. Type your address, enter your rent, and see in 20 seconds whether you are paying fair. Building by building, not suburb by suburb.